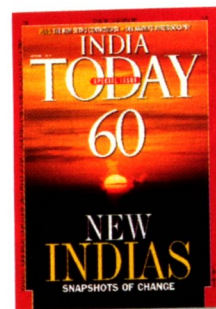


MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



"60 New Indias",
October 1, 2007

"India at 60 is on a move. Ironically it is also at war with itself. The nation can do wonders if provided with a strong and selfless leadership."

S.C. KAPOOR, *Noida*

Country Tales

India's makeover in the past two decades is akin to a typewriter being replaced by a computer ("Snapshots of Change", October 1). However, the transformation of the country would have been faster and more vibrant if our nation had honest leadership and bureaucracy.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

An issue like this makes me proud to be an Indian and forces me to write back. One would like to see more of such positive issues on the country rather than the sleazy stuff that the media usually comes up with.
PRITI J., *Bangkok*

The snapshots of change, though impressive and informative, do not present the complete picture of the country. Despite economic growth, the benefits of change are yet to percolate

to the rural poor. Development is still skewed in favour of the urban rich.
K.S. THAMPI, *Chennai*

One would like to add a 61st story to the special issue, that of the magazine INDIA TODAY which has gone to great lengths to bring out an issue, which is both delightful and inspiring.
GIRISH U. PAI, *Mumbai*

The issue captured beautifully the butterfly of a billion colours that India is. It helped one understand the metamorphosis that the country is undergoing.
MADHURIKA SANKAR, *on e-mail*

The piece on Baba Ramdev was laced with cynicism and sarcasm, evident in the title, and did not go with the magazine's theme of recounting remarkable feats and achievements of a New India ("The Karma Chameleon", October 1). The author seems to see

everything in red a la Brinda Karat even though yoga has benefited millions in the country.
SHANTI PRAKASH KARIR, *Noida*

Religious Bridge

Secularism in India, unlike the West, is not about the negation of religion but promoting inclusiveness of religious practices ("The Evidence About Ram", October 1). ASI's controversial affidavit makes a mockery of this principle by denying the people the right to hold certain religious beliefs.
S. BALAKRISHNAN, *Jamshedpur*

The demand for "incontrovertible proof" to prove the existence of Lord Ram brings to light the so-called secular brigade's half-baked understanding of the concept of religion and makes a mockery of the Hindu sentiments. It only highlights the intellectual bankruptcy of the caretakers of the nation.
ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Lord Ram created everything and there's no way that a single bridge can be taken as His sole creation and representation. If a government wants to modify one of his creations, it should be taken in the right spirit.
C. SRINIVASAN,
Rhodes, Australia

The Ram Sethu proposal is about dredging the sea to allow heavy ships to traverse the strait. Instead, it has been converted into a clash of egos between the Dravidians and the Aryans. Will we ever display a sense of balance?
K.R. RAVI, *USA*

After demolishing a 400-year-old tomb in Gujarat, the same party is now opposing progress and development in the name of religion. Such examples reveal what Indian secularism actually is all about.
MAHFOOZ ALAM, *on e-mail*